

Notes on parameterization of manipulators via twists,

MLS Chapter 3, Section 2.3

On deriving eq. (3.9) p. 94:

One can define the following transformations for the manipulator in the initial configuration:

$$\begin{aligned}
 g_{l_0 l_2} &= g_{l_0 l_1} g_{l_1 l_2} \\
 g_{l_0 l_3} &= g_{l_0 l_1} g_{l_1 l_2} g_{l_2 l_3} \\
 g_{l_0 l_4} &= g_{l_0 l_1} g_{l_1 l_2} g_{l_2 l_3} g_{l_3 l_4} \\
 &\vdots \\
 g_{l_0 l_{n-1}} &= g_{l_0 l_1} g_{l_1 l_2} g_{l_2 l_3} \cdots g_{l_{n-2} l_{n-1}} \\
 g_{l_0 l_n} &= g_{l_0 t} = g_{l_0 l_1} g_{l_1 l_2} g_{l_2 l_3} \cdots g_{l_{n-1} t} = g_{l_0 l_1} g_{l_1 l_2} g_{l_2 l_3} \cdots g_{l_{n-1} l_n}
 \end{aligned}$$

where each transformation g on the right hand side of the above equation set is to be interpreted as the one of the g -transformations in the right hand side of eq. (3.8). Then, also,

$$\begin{aligned}
 g_{l_0 l_2}^{-1} &= g_{l_1 l_2}^{-1} g_{l_0 l_1}^{-1} \\
 g_{l_0 l_3}^{-1} &= g_{l_2 l_3}^{-1} g_{l_1 l_2}^{-1} g_{l_0 l_1}^{-1} \\
 g_{l_0 l_4}^{-1} &= g_{l_3 l_4}^{-1} g_{l_2 l_3}^{-1} g_{l_1 l_2}^{-1} g_{l_0 l_1}^{-1} \\
 &\vdots \\
 g_{l_0 l_{n-1}}^{-1} &= g_{l_{n-2} l_{n-1}}^{-1} \cdots g_{l_2 l_3}^{-1} g_{l_1 l_2}^{-1} g_{l_0 l_1}^{-1} \\
 g_{l_0 t}^{-1} &= g_{l_{n-1} t}^{-1} \cdots g_{l_2 l_3}^{-1} g_{l_1 l_2}^{-1} g_{l_0 l_1}^{-1}
 \end{aligned}$$

Eq. (3.8) is re-written here, in red:

$$g_{st}(\theta) = e^{\hat{\xi}_{01}\theta_1} g_{l_0 l_1}(0) e^{\hat{\xi}_{12}\theta_2} g_{l_1 l_2}(0) \cdots e^{\hat{\xi}_{n-2,n-1}\theta_{n-1}} g_{l_{n-2} l_{n-1}}(0) e^{\hat{\xi}_{n-1,n}\theta_n} g_{l_{n-1} l_n}(0) .$$

This equation can be re-written, colour-coded, as follows, where the red factors are what were present in the original eq. (3.8), while the black factors were inserted without really changing the equation, because they appear in matrix-inverse-times-matrix pairs:

$$\begin{aligned}
 g_{st}(\theta) &= e^{\hat{\xi}_{01}\theta_1} g_{l_0 l_1}(0) e^{\hat{\xi}_{12}\theta_2} g_{l_0 l_1}^{-1}(0) g_{l_0 l_1}(0) g_{l_1 l_2}(0) e^{\hat{\xi}_{23}\theta_3} g_{l_1 l_2}^{-1}(0) g_{l_0 l_1}^{-1}(0) g_{l_0 l_1}(0) g_{l_1 l_2}(0) g_{l_2 l_3}(0) \\
 &\quad \cdots e^{\hat{\xi}_{n-2,n-1}\theta_{n-1}} g_{l_{n-3} l_{n-2}}^{-1}(0) \cdots g_{l_2 l_3}^{-1}(0) g_{l_1 l_2}^{-1}(0) g_{l_0 l_1}^{-1}(0) g_{l_0 l_1}(0) g_{l_1 l_2}(0) g_{l_2 l_3}(0) \\
 &\quad \cdots g_{l_{n-3} l_{n-2}}(0) g_{l_{n-2} l_{n-1}}(0) e^{\hat{\xi}_{n-1,n}\theta_n} g_{l_{n-2} l_{n-1}}(0)^{-1} \cdots g_{l_2 l_3}^{-1}(0) g_{l_1 l_2}^{-1}(0) g_{l_0 l_1}^{-1}(0) g_{l_0 l_1}(0) \\
 &\quad g_{l_1 l_2}(0) g_{l_2 l_3}(0) \cdots g_{l_{n-2} l_{n-1}}(0) g_{l_{n-1} l_n}(0)
 \end{aligned}$$

The equation set stated above is now used to simplify this:

$$\begin{aligned}
 g_{st}(\theta) &= e^{\hat{\xi}_{01}\theta_1} \left(g_{l_0 l_1}(0) e^{\hat{\xi}_{12}\theta_2} g_{l_0 l_1}^{-1}(0) \right) \left(g_{l_0 l_2}(0) e^{\hat{\xi}_{23}\theta_3} g_{l_0 l_2}^{-1}(0) \right) \left(g_{l_0 l_3}(0) e^{\hat{\xi}_{34}\theta_4} g_{l_0 l_3}^{-1}(0) \right) \\
 &\quad \cdots \left(g_{l_0 l_{n-1}}(0) e^{\hat{\xi}_{n-1,n}\theta_n} g_{l_0 l_{n-1}}^{-1}(0) \right) g_{l_0 t}(0) ,
 \end{aligned}$$

which is the same as eq. (3.9).